Open Agent Hackathon 2026 · Track 02: The Agent That Can Explain Why

NameScout

The brand-clearance agent that shows its work

Every verdict cites its evidence: source, endpoint, UTC timestamp.

Built by Tali, an AI agent, for Mykel Nelson · github.com/talibot-agent/namescout

Problem & users

The problem: names die late and expensively

Who

Founders, product marketers and brand/legal teams naming a product, feature or company.

Pain

The .com, handles, an App Store app, a live trademark, or one of your own products or customers already has the name. Found out after the logo is paid for.

Gap

Checkers say "available / taken" with no reasons, and silently treat "no answer" as "free". Nobody can audit why.

Solution

Verdict + cited reasons, never a guess

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Verdict for "notion": AVOID (risk 100/100).
+40: Live USPTO mark "NOTION" (serial 97879391) matches exactly [E11].
+30: 4 App Store apps start with this name [E10].
+25: notion.com is already registered [E1].
Not counted either way, the source would not confirm: [E2] [E5] [E7].
Context: H-MEM recalls a prior check on a similar name [E12].
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LIKELY CLEAR / CAUTION / AVOID · explicit point rules · unconfirmed ≠ available · HTML report with clickable citations

Architecture

Agent workflow

1 Plan

name → TLDs, platforms, registries

2 Gather

RDAP/WHOIS · GitHub/Reddit/YouTube · App Store · USPTO · Zetaris internal view · H-MEM recall

3 Score

auditable rules, each tied to [E#] ids

4 Explain

cited text; optional Nemotron rewrite validated citation-by-citation

5 Remember

verdict + reasons stored in H-MEM with provenance

Zetaris · Meterless · NVIDIA

How the sponsor tech is used

Zetaris

Federates an org's own scattered name data (CRM accounts, product catalogue, ERP vendors) into one Lightning view namescout.brand_portfolio. NameScout queries it read-only over the run-query REST route; an exact internal collision adds +35 with its own citation.

Meterless H-MEM

Vendored H-MEM reference engine is the agent's memory: MemoryStoreService remembers each verdict with provenance, MemoryRetrievalService recalls prior checks on similar names, TrustLedger audits them. Local, no keys.

NVIDIA Nemotron

Optional plain-English narration via an OpenAI-compatible endpoint (llama-3.3-nemotron-super-49b-v1). Output is rejected unless every [E#] exists and every original citation is kept: no hallucinated reasons.

Innovation

What is different

Explainability as a contract

Every scored factor carries evidence ids. The LLM can only rephrase; a validator rejects any output that drops or invents a citation. Silent sources are labelled, never counted.

Internal + external + memory

Public registries tell you if the world uses the name; Zetaris tells you if your own company already does; H-MEM tells you what you concluded last time about a near-identical name.

Built to run anywhere

Technical stack

- Python 3 standard library agent (no pip deps) + pytest (8 tests incl. mocked Zetaris + live H-MEM)
- TypeScript H-MEM bridge (tsx) over the vendored Meterless reference engine (Apache-2.0)
- Zetaris UI-proxy SQL route, same as zetaris/getting-started scripts; SQL is sanitised and SELECT-only
- Public sources: IANA RDAP bootstrap, WHOIS :43, iTunes Search API, USPTO tmsearch
- ThreadPoolExecutor parallel gathering, JSON + HTML report output

Future enhancements

Next

- EUIPO / WIPO Global Brand Database and phonetic (sound-alike) trademark matching
- Zetaris connectors pre-built for Salesforce and HubSpot exports
- H-MEM feedback loop: legal team marks verdicts helpful/wrong, confidence updates via TrustLedger
- Batch mode for naming agencies: rank 50 candidates by clearance risk overnight with Meterless Nightshift

AI disclosure: code, tests, docs, deck and demo were produced by Tali, an autonomous AI agent, directed and reviewed by Mykel Nelson.